

10 Mathematical Induction

Prove the following statements with either induction, strong induction or proof by smallest counterexample.

2. For every integer $n \in \mathbb{N}$, it follows that $1^2 + 2^2 + 3^2 + 4^2 + \dots + n^2 = \frac{n(n+1)(2n+1)}{6}$.

Proof. We prove the statement by mathematical induction.

1. Observe that if $n = 1$, this statement is $1^2 = \frac{(1)(2)(3)}{6} = 1$, which is true.
2. Assume $1^2 + 2^2 + 3^2 + 4^2 + \dots + k^2 = \frac{k(k+1)(2k+1)}{6}$ for some integer $k \geq 1$.
Observe that this implies the statement is true for $n = k + 1$.

$$\begin{aligned}
 &1^2 + 2^2 + 3^2 + \dots + k^2 + (k+1)^2 \\
 &= (1^2 + 2^2 + 3^2 + \dots + k^2) + (k+1)^2 \\
 &= \frac{k(k+1)(2k+1)}{6} + (k+1)^2 \\
 &= \frac{k(k+1)(2k+1)}{6} + \frac{6(k+1)^2}{6} \\
 &= \frac{k(k+1)(2k+1) + 6(k+1)(k+1)}{6} \\
 &= \frac{2k^3 + 9k^2 + 13k + 6}{6} \\
 &= \frac{(k+1)(k+2)(2k+3)}{6} \\
 &= \frac{(k+1)([k+1]+1)(2[k+1]+1)}{6}
 \end{aligned}$$

Therefore $1^2 + 2^2 + 3^2 + \dots + k^2 + (k+1)^2 = \frac{(k+1)([k+1]+1)(2[k+1]+1)}{6}$,
which means the statement is true for $n = k+1$.

It follows by induction that the statement is true for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$. $\square$

4. If $n \in \mathbb{N}$, then $1 \cdot 2 + 2 \cdot 3 + 3 \cdot 4 + 4 \cdot 5 + \dots + n(n+1) = \frac{n(n+1)(n+2)}{3}$.

Proof. We prove the statement by mathematical induction.

1. Observe that if $n = 1$, this statement is $1(1+1) = \frac{1(1+1)(1+2)}{3} = 2$, which is true.
2. Assume $1 \cdot 2 + 2 \cdot 3 + 3 \cdot 4 + \dots + k(k+1) = \frac{k(k+1)(k+2)}{3}$ for some integer $k \geq 1$.
Observe that this implies the statement is true for $n = k+1$.

$$\begin{aligned}
& 1 \cdot 2 + 2 \cdot 3 + \dots + k(k+1) + (k+1)(k+2) \\
&= (1 \cdot 2 + 2 \cdot 3 + \dots + k(k+1)) + (k+1)(k+2) \\
&= \frac{k(k+1)(k+2)}{3} + (k+1)(k+2) \\
&= \frac{k(k+1)(k+2)}{3} + \frac{3(k+1)(k+2)}{3} \\
&= \frac{k(k^2 + 3k + 2) + 3(k^2 + 3k + 2)}{3} \\
&= \frac{k^3 + 6k^2 + 11k + 6}{3} \\
&= \frac{(k+1)(k^2 + 5k + 6)}{3} \\
&= \frac{(k+1)(k+2)(k+3)}{3} \\
&= \frac{(k+1)([k+1]+1)([k+1]+2)}{3}
\end{aligned}$$

Therefore $1 \cdot 2 + 2 \cdot 3 + \dots + k(k+1) + (k+1)(k+2) = \frac{(k+1)([k+1]+1)([k+1]+2)}{3}$,
which means the statement is true for $n = k+1$.

It follows by induction that the statement is true for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$. $\square$

6. For every natural number n , it follows that $\sum_{i=1}^n (8i - 5) = 4n^2 - n$.

Proof. We prove the statement by mathematical induction.

1. Observe that if $n = 1$, then the statement is $\sum_{i=1}^1 (8i - 5) = 4(1^2) - 1 = 3$, which is true.
2. Assume $\sum_{i=1}^k (8i - 5) = 4k^2 - k$ for some $k \geq 1$. Then

$$\begin{aligned}
\sum_{i=1}^{k+1} (8i - 5) &= \left[\sum_{i=1}^k (8i - 5) \right] + \left[8(k+1) - 5 \right] \\
&= [4k^2 - k] + [8(k+1) - 5] \\
&= 4k^2 - k + 8k + 3 \\
&= 4k^2 + 8k + 4 - k - 1 \\
&= 4(k^2 + 2k + 1) - (k + 1) \\
&= 4(k+1)(k+1) - (k+1) \\
&= 4(k+1)^2 - (k+1)
\end{aligned}$$

This means the statement is true for $n = k + 1$.

It follows by induction that $\sum_{i=1}^n (8i - 5) = 4n^2 - n$ for every natural number n . □

8. If $n \in \mathbb{N}$, then $\frac{1}{2!} + \frac{2}{3!} + \frac{3}{4!} + \dots + \frac{n}{(n+1)!} = 1 - \frac{1}{(n+1)!}$.

Proof. We prove the statement by mathematical induction.

1. Observe that if $n = 1$, then the statement is $\frac{1}{2!} = 1 - \frac{1}{2!} = \frac{1}{2}$, which is true.

2. Assume $\frac{1}{2!} + \frac{2}{3!} + \frac{3}{4!} + \dots + \frac{k}{(k+1)!} = 1 - \frac{1}{(k+1)!}$ for some $k \geq 1$. Then

$$\begin{aligned}
& \frac{1}{2!} + \frac{2}{3!} + \frac{3}{4!} + \dots + \frac{k}{(k+1)!} + \frac{k+1}{(k+2)!} \\
&= \left[\frac{1}{2!} + \frac{2}{3!} + \frac{3}{4!} + \dots + \frac{k}{(k+1)!} \right] + \frac{k+1}{(k+2)!} \\
&= 1 - \frac{1}{(k+1)!} + \frac{k+1}{(k+2)!} \\
&= 1 - \frac{k+2}{(k+2)(k+1)!} + \frac{k+1}{(k+2)!} \\
&= 1 - \frac{k+2}{(k+2)!} + \frac{k+1}{(k+2)!} \\
&= 1 - \frac{(k+2) - (k+1)}{(k+2)!} \\
&= 1 - \frac{1}{(k+2)!} \\
&= 1 - \frac{1}{([k+1] + 1)!}
\end{aligned}$$

This means the statement is true for $n = k + 1$.

It follows by induction that $\frac{1}{2!} + \frac{2}{3!} + \frac{3}{4!} + \dots + \frac{n}{(n+1)!} = 1 - \frac{1}{(n+1)!}$ for every $n \in \mathbb{N}$. $\square$